

and business partners—if you wish to incorporate their digital signatures—is also provided. This feature will be useful when you are collaborating and working on a legal or contractual document.

You can import documents of the following formats: HTML, .doc, .sxw (OpenOffice.org), .odt, .rtf, and text. You can also import images in these formats: JPEG, GIF, PNG, and text files. Zoho supports document imports both from your PC as well as a specified URL. When importing from a URL it can be a bit picky, and it won't import the document if you don't start the URL with the "http://" prefix. You can give it a specific document name or accept the name Zoho suggests. Like with Google Docs, you can also e-mail HTML and .doc documents into Zoho at a unique e-mail address for your account. Click the Import button to get a quick view of this e-mail ID. However, note that Zoho does not currently support the Office 2007 formats.

After having worked on Desktop suites, most of the command buttons icons will be familiar, and in any case, descriptive tool-tips pop up when you hover over the buttons. Almost all the usual shortcut keys will work, including [Ctrl] + [S] for saving a document. There is a small learning curve in identifying the layout of the buttons as most may not be exactly where you expect it to be. Once you've familiarised yourself with the interface, working with Zoho Writer is a breeze. You'll miss some of the advanced features in MS Word you've gotten addicted to, but in most cases your needs can be met with the functionality provided by Zoho Writer at an unbeatable price (Free!).

7.1.2 Zoho Sheet

Very similar with respect to the generic collaboration features and functionality found in Zoho Writer is Zoho Sheet. As a basic spreadsheet, Zoho Sheet is a powerful tool in its own right, but you'll need to get over the desire to have Excel-like ease of use. Remember, these are still the early days of Web-based applications, so some amount of functionality will be missing—but you've all the basics in place to get productive right away.